

In honor of the wedding of Chaim and Bracha Mandel, our dear grandchildren.

Baruch Hashem, we are in the midst of preparing for a fantastic, beautiful שמחה. In recognition of that, we will find a connection between פרשת תצוה and the upcoming שמחה between Chaim and Bracha.

The **הַנֶּחֱד קָפָה** שִׁיר הַשִּׁירִים (א:ט"ו) in פסוק on מדרש נחומא (תצוה ה':ה) There is a **וְאַתָּה תַּצְנֶנָּה** begins with פרשה. The **מֵה הַיּוֹנָה הַבִּיָּאָה אוֹרָה לְעוֹלָם**, אף אַתָּם שְׁנַמְשְׁלֶתֶם כִּיּוֹנָה, מדרש explains: “your eyes are like doves.” – **עֵינֶיךָ יוֹנִים** שֶׁמֶן זַיִת וְהַדְלִיקוּ – just as the יוֹנָה, in various ways, brings light to the world, so too, you bring **וְאַתָּה תַּצְנֶנָּה וְיִקְהוּ אֵלֶיךָ שְׁמֶן זַיִת** light it, and bring illumination. This is the meaning behind **וְאַתָּה תַּצְנֶנָּה וְיִקְהוּ אֵלֶיךָ שְׁמֶן זַיִת**.

The ספרים ask, in what way does שמן זית, or the יונה for that matter, bring light to the world?

The answer lies in the הסתפקות - contentment and satisfaction. One who is content with what he has brings light to the world. This is exactly what we find with the יונה in the story of נה. The יונה preferred מרוצים from מזונות מרוצים rather than receiving sweet מרוצים from מרוצים. The ספרים explain that the word תצוה is not only a צוה of command but also comes from the צוה of ציוה of attachment, connection. This is found in the ספר תפוחי חיים, written by R' Chaim Alter Panet, which is related to the name of Benet, the famous R' Benet, [which people ask me at least once a year if I am related to him, which I'm not].

This idea of הסתפקות is also reflected in the יווני's loyalty and faithfulness to its mate and family. Similarly, שמן זית, which כלל ישראל brings, represents this מדה, as oil is known not to intermingle or mix with any other liquid. Oil remains distinct and separate, refusing to blend with anything else, symbolizing steadfastness to its source. The gemara (תענית כ"ד ע"א) says that a פְּלֵה שְׁעִיבָהּ פֹתָהּ, meaning she is satisfied and content, does not require further evaluation, because this very quality reveals a special מדה within her. This elevated trait of הסתפקות defines her as a wonderful נשמה and a truly special person.

So ואתה תצננה - if the הקדוש ברוך הוא sees that you are satisfied, that you're content, then the שכינה will rest upon you and rest upon the house. שכינה שרוי בניהם. This idea is also connected to the מנורה, which brings light. Light is a symbol of satisfaction, comfort, and joy. When the מנורה is lit, it serves as an עדות that the שכינה is בשרואל ישראל.

This concept is also fundamental to הדלקת נרות which is done every שבת by the אשת חיל. Chazal were מתקן שולום בית to signify and to increase שולום בית. The best way is with שמן זית, then there will be even more שולום בית in the house.

It's a great lesson for us all, a great lesson to learn, and in our hectic society, we're constantly seeking more and more and more. Maybe we should stop and take a moment to reflect and be satisfied with what we've got. The last word is (אבות ד'א'): **הַשְׂמֵחַ בְּהִלְקוֹ, אֵיזֶהוּ עֲשִׂירַי**. The true richness in the world, the true satisfaction, is in being satisfied with what **הַקָּדוֹשׁ בְּרוּךְ הוּא** gives us. Not to say the famous line of the rich man, "I just want a little bit more". Let us be happy with what we've got. Let us be satisfied and walk around happy all the time, happy with our lives, happy with our families, and Baruch Hashem, we should have a lot of **בְּרָכָה** from all of them. And I'm looking forward to a huge **שִׂמְחָה**.

